

Management System Documentation Hierarchy

L1 · Strategic Level: Policies & Objectives

POLICIES: Documented information established by top management that is appropriate to the purpose and context of the organization, provides a framework for setting objectives, and includes a commitment to satisfy applicable requirements and to continual improvement.

OBJECTIVES: Documented information defining results to be achieved. Must be consistent with the policy, measurable (if practicable), take into account applicable requirements, be monitored, communicated, and updated as appropriate.

L2 · System and Process Level: IMS Description & Architecture

MANAGEMENT SYSTEM MANUAL: Documented information providing an overview of the management system, which dictates the structure, format, content, or method of presentation for documenting the management system.

PROCESS MAPS: Documented information necessary to support the operation of processes. Determines the inputs required and the outputs expected, and the sequence and interaction of these processes.

ORGANIZATIONAL CHARTS: Documented information representing the structure of the organization, showing responsibilities, authorities, and interrelationships.

L3 · Operational Level: Procedures & Work Instructions

PROCEDURES: Maintained documented information specifying the established way to carry out an activity or a process.

WORK INSTRUCTIONS: Maintained documented information providing detailed descriptions of how to perform and record specific tasks.

L4 · Data Capture Level: Forms & Checklists

FORMS AND CHECKLISTS: Documented information developed and maintained to record data demonstrating compliance with the requirements of the management system

L5 · Evidence Level: Records

RETAINED DOCUMENTED INFORMATION / RECORDS: Documented information retained for providing evidence of results achieved. Provides objective evidence that processes are being carried out as planned and that the management system is operating effectively.

L6 · External Documentation Level

DOCUMENTED INFORMATION OF EXTERNAL ORIGIN: Documented information determined by the organization to be necessary for the planning and operation of the management system, which must be identified as appropriate and controlled.